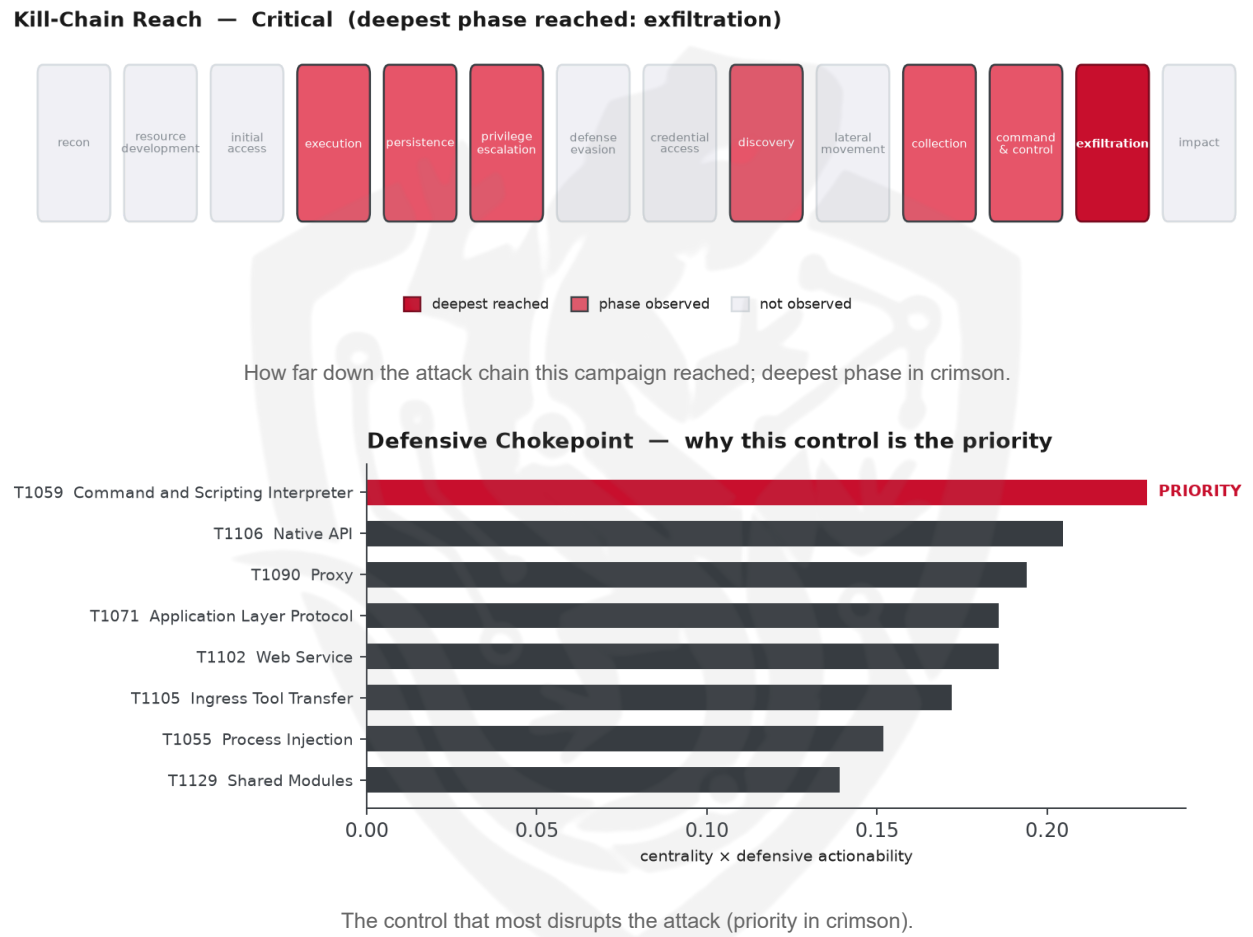


THREAT REPORT: UNKNOWN_ADVERSARY

TENCSHELL MALWARE CAMPAIGN

Visual Summary



Summary

The observed cluster of activity has been linked to the use of TencShell malware, targeting the manufacturing sector. The threat actor's identity and targeted country remain unknown. Priority should be given to constraining scripting interpreters to prevent further exploitation. The operational risk band for this threat is considered critical due to the potential for exfiltration.

Threat Overview

The threat actor, whose identity is currently insufficient to determine, has been observed utilizing the TencShell malware family. The central vulnerability exploited in this campaign is unknown. The manufacturing sector has been targeted, with various techniques used to achieve the actor's goals, including data exfiltration and system discovery.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The attack chain involves a series of techniques, including process injection, masquerading, and exfiltration over command and control channels. The priority technique identified is T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter, which serves as a critical chokepoint in the attack chain. To mitigate this threat, the recommended priority control is to "Constrain PowerShell for unprivileged users (Constrained Language Mode + AppLocker); enable script-block logging; block wscript/cscript where unneeded."

Infrastructure and Corroboration

There is currently no observed hosting provider or ASN associated with this campaign. According to abuse.ch, the malware family used in this campaign is unknown. AbuseIPDB has not flagged any indicators with a confidence level of 80% or higher, with the highest confidence seen being 0%.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1005 Data from Local System
- T1036 Masquerading
- T1041 Exfiltration Over C2 Channel
- T1055 Process Injection
- T1057 Process Discovery
- T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter
- T1071 Application Layer Protocol
- T1082 System Information Discovery
- T1083 File and Directory Discovery
- T1090 Proxy
- T1102 Web Service
- T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer
- T1106 Native API
- T1113 Screen Capture
- T1129 Shared Modules
- T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution
- T1548 Abuse Elevation Control Mechanism

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter (centrality 0.2867).
- Operational risk: Critical (score 0.968, reaches exfiltration).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.4602; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
APT37	0.4602
Windigo	0.4583
Gamaredon Group	0.3814
Inception	0.3744
Windshift	0.3466

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.
- Malware families corroborated by abuse.ch: Unknown malware.
- Note: enrichment raises the severity signal (an IOC at or above 80% AbuseIPDB confidence, or a confirmed malware-family hit). This is context, not a change to the source assessment.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator	Context
Domain	gin-tne-fahcesmukw[.]cn-hangzhou[.]fcapp[.]run	Unknown malware
Hash	cdb9d76093d0938f30d93bcce4f58b13b4b21c9188eea387c6d9ec6f4cb4aad4	
Hash	12986838bf5c0b638edca3ac84c9e18f	
Hash	1da53ba0766c902a50ba40271b82e557	
Hash	20150ed3ac726c486d60b2be05ee2b74	
Hash	2c3e4e7219e33327915a4371051fe84f	
Hash	35f56e4a65b73a29e446b13eaff7eede	

Type	Indicator	Context
Hash	4dbb6a1ae553dc9659cd734fc5586f8c	
Hash	7aa333c814c9ac618ae2fab66a6eddef	
Hash	d8d4e5be6f2014d17001f3a5ac7c1dcf	
Hash	debb2b7123e2b024ac6ae77c1aa59da2	
Hash	f819c42f5e5dafc87d770cb8f6af8b11	
Hash	3874881233450ced72e743e3d9e6e3a7f0dc7ff9	
Hash	3d56fb150811ef2d5769b15cca5d3c363edfb926	
Hash	552ea6e21dbd17054db51c61607aadee910d6f13	
Hash	637c77e4b952ca38410f68c1fdcc3e57e75858ef	
Hash	6c972d0f0f8c11c28272826add94f4e16e59dda1	
Hash	7412708f87194b3dc27b776840d83d7965aabc5c	
Hash	93da3d6daf2ab0433f19d04e28e4736458f5606a	
Hash	e6229e69ace3adb6c6d59354c21e9de30fba0c50	
Hash	f6a4b3937dc373549e8f81eb29bfd2454e6e05a7	
Hash	fb3484f3b344c89c9c8f56348585e5f0cfc69f68	
Hash	01dc3e7e673b4f2682f29b19ecabf9a6ec9c3042c9b1cfb39dbdddf1dda680ab	
Hash	065c54893e4777d52be6b7bf30b832d5ffd9d96fd178642a5828a364c0e904a0	
Hash	065f5a605ac04d5f443089b65aa1393414ee38c4ee8f780e7d78c06b46504ae4	
Hash	06776635e386d536b1b0fc21e6aa41865d44d83dae5e9b109868d71ca309eeaa	
Hash	0fe91200a2bb4aed13b1a1ba4ec8fd4454566f5929ffed4f537d9a87c1bf1187	
Hash	12c6d0e603386b81751d95b32d1698d794c99343abb06d066b0f6060e8690aca	
Hash	12f76f48727916d6c05f53f8cd94915db5de5ffcbfa02c4807c27e090cfa47c1	
Hash	1329be66458962dabfa20185c230439c57d32b90a20de791afdce9c15226fccb	
Hash	147f86854690ba096f3797c623b66365d6adbf7140d7d7c3dcf746b83a4b6dac	
Hash	1ba73df60e12b3feb8b5574e65cfceb6910460ab7fae2cf5554769fafdad049e	

Type	Indicator	Context
Hash	1d2e37b41d616ecb32b8bd2f2a52c792f1808fdc938574fc366d737b6f643c61	
Hash	2012ff4d7c36e42d256d78c265f242d29a305af66686866c581ee96c2b05d5a6	
Hash	2a010bd1061e11da6f5cf951a3ebd23503916e159e3d486cc722b4b8b4a099c9	
Hash	31635e4667eba1ba3588e1bc9c05d18a78d9693c801e5176e6cddf74e0d5bcc2	
Hash	37facbbd0047c19f4efdea75ccb9e3ec793cb9b1d7846afa4fb8e900d6e9ed95	
Hash	3ffe3a6f328a6459624bd93edd206e2256b2753e17137cbc1530b91fa325ecac	
Hash	4ae8de40153c66455d972e6e98fe06fb68db7301ba126557e96599527bc5509c	
Hash	5ac484ec0846fff8f099b234dfd1602864300da8c68b01822c6036eb709fc584	

Reputation by AbuseIPDB · malware attribution by abuse.ch · Geo/ASN data by IP2Location LITE.

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter (execution)
- **Observed here:** the threat actor used T1106 Native API here as an alternative execution technique.
- **Projected pivot:** T1106 Native API (execution)
- **Basis:** observed in this campaign (an alternative the actor already demonstrated).

The actor could pivot to using T1106 Native API to bypass the blocked command and scripting interpreter control, potentially allowing them to continue interacting with the system at a lower level. They may leverage Native API to execute system calls directly, which would likely enable them to maintain some level of access and control. To counter this, the defensive control of Enable EDR API-telemetry; alert on unusual direct Native API use from non-system processes should be implemented.

- **Defensive countermeasure:** Enable EDR API-telemetry; alert on unusual direct Native API use from non-system processes.